There's Been a Slight Mistake – Rehab 3 A.M.

By Ally Sheedy

INTRODUCTION

Ally Sheedy, famous for her roles in The Breakfast Club and St. Elmo's Fire back in the 1980's, had a live that wasn't always sunshine and roses. She suffered from recurrent bouts of bulimia. She had an abortion at 16. She was addicted to drugs and contemplated suicide. Finally, in 1989, a group of friends led by Demi Moore handed her an airplane ticket to the famous Hazelden Foundation rehab clinic in Minnesota. It was there that she learned to rely on her poetry as a way of understanding her turbulent emotions. But at first . . . at first . . . she was convinced There's Been a Slight Mistake . . . Rehab at 3 AM by Ally Sheedy.

There's been a slight mistake, Miss

I don't know where I am

See, the last thing I remember

We were in some L.A. traffic jam –

(God, who the hell was that I was with?)

Anyway –

I think there was an airplane and a Xanax and some chips –

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oh, God – and

YES

a Rolling Stone – (whew!)

and a Halcion and –

SEE! – of course, all over me, these

cherry ice cream drips.

I remember now. I was going on a trip! . . . going . . .

. . . somewhere . . . with . . . someone – who? . . . I'm losing

it . . .

. . . and . . . THEN . . . .

ummmmm – there's been a slight mistake, Miss . . .

Is this the office of Hazelden?

OH SHIT. OK – OK.

I'll laugh. I get it.

Jokes are going down.

AHA! Oh, God, it's *funny* now!

My L.A. friends are crazy clowns!

I mean, I don't belong here. And, as you see, I'm fine.

Do you have some Tylenol 3? I've had a hell of a time.

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Well – HA! Looks like we've both been had!

Can you call me a cab? RIGHT NOW!?!!

I have important meetings soon and

I-AM-GETTING-MAD

I'm not signing shit, Miss Nurse. Will you pick up the

goddamn phone?

I'm telling you – there's been a slight mistake

and I am going home!

Excuse me. I just lost my temper.

Do you have some water or soda?

And, nurse, you still aren't calling, nurse.

(You're the kind of controlling bitch I keep meeting in

CODA)

Please just tell me where I am . . . where? . . .

. . . you must be loaded . . .

There is no way that I can be I fucking

Central City Minnesota!

I DON'T HAVE A DRUG PROBLEM.

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It's all a slight mistake, nurse-Bitch.

(God, I'm hot)

I never had *any* kind of a problem –

Demi, you little witch

Excuse me. I just got angry there.

God, it's hot. My eyeballs itch.

Nurse, there's been a slight mistake.

It's all a little trick.

We both know those beds belong to *addicts* –

Who are – you know –

Really sick.

What? Me? Oh, no, not *addiction*, miss Nurse.

Cause I never shot a needle in my vein.

I could use, maybe, a hit of Valium, though

To kill this FUCKING red pain.

NOW, RATCHETT, *NOW*.

Sorry. I don't mean to sound crude.

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I could use a little help here and,
you're being very rude.
I'm not supposed to be here.
There's been this slight mistake.
Someon'es out to do me in and
I have too much career at stake.
Listen, Nurse, you gotta hear –
Yes, hon, you're *being* polite –
please, babe,
the Valium is just my way to lessen
my creative artist's fright.

I was never meant to come here, really.
--and I would never use drugs.
But before I go, can you suck out my veins?
They're crawling with thousands of bugs!
OK, fine, don't help me, Nurse,
I'm not staying in this hellhole place.
You don't get me at all, do you?
I can see it in your nasty old face.

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So can you just let me use that phone?
No?
Can you just give me some aspirins in a glass?
And will you get those fuckin rehab forms away from me –
I AM CLAM --
Before I shove them up your ass?

That was my beginning at Hazelden
and I'm glad I stayed that night
I'm sorry I broke that door down and ran
I feel like that nurse helped me save my own life.

Lately she's even smiled at me when I've come into Med.
for my drugs
Still I pray every day to awaken released
from the itching of
crawling black bugs.

I guess I've decided that this isn't jail –
It's more like a "drug camp," they've said –
I'm even starting to love the strange lumpy pillows

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on my own
seldom slept-in bed.
And something happened suddenly.

Yesterday I saw the sun.
Something in my head had cleared
And I realized there *was* one.
I stopped in its Light
From somewhere in the bushes I was hearing heaving sighs
And realizing they came from me
I took a breath
and closed my eyes.
I breathed in the River
Breathed the trees
Breathed all around the sky
and in the wind I breathed my God
Who had not let me die.
I've been very tired; it's been a long time
Since I've really known where I've been
My heart started pounding and beating with love
Aliveness was just flowing in

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"I am here!" I screamed. "I'm alive!"
and fuck it
I let those tears run
I'm gonna get back and I'm gonna get through
"I'm gonna make this" I said to no one.
So I kept walking and thinking about what drugs ad my sickness
had done
and that certain faces
like Alec's and Jane's and Demi's
were like God and my sun
And all my friends who spoke ad cared and broke my heart

to intervene
And those who have been there: junkies and dealers and drunks
who believe in me
I breathed them inside me
every one
and all that my own Higher Power has done.

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Excuse me, Miss; excuse me nurse

There is no slight mistake been done

I opened up my rehab door and knew

that home was truly where I'd come.

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Ally Sheedy
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AWARD HISTORY

2002 National Qualifier
2008 National Qualifier
2009 National Qualifier
2016 National Qualifier - MS
MN State Qualifier

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